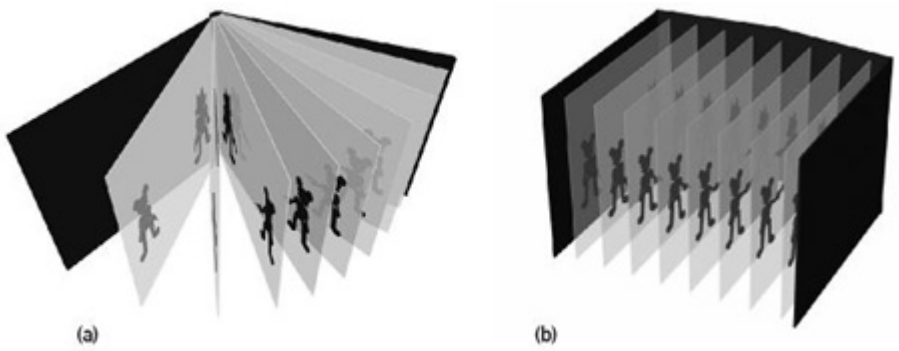


Figure 3.3 **(**a**)** Flip book of duel. **(**b**)** Flip book with expanded binding.

Here is the key point: Just as Lisa realized that there are different, equally valid ways to slice up a region of space into streets and avenues,

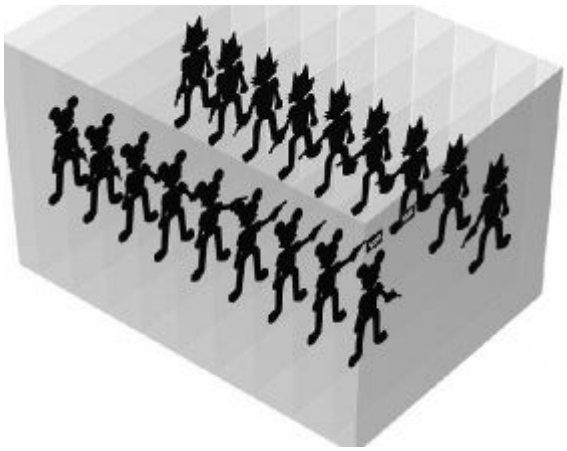


Figure 3.3 **(**c**)** Block of spacetime containing the duel. Pages, or "time slices," organize the events in the block. The spaces between slices are for visual clarity only; they are not meant to suggest that time is discrete, a question we discuss later.

Einstein realized that there are different, equally valid ways to slice up a region of spacetime—a block like that in Figure 3.3c—into regions of space at moments of time. *The pages in Figures 3.3a, b, and c*—with, again, each page denoting one moment of time—*provide but one of the many possible slicings.* This may sound like only a minor extension of what we know intuitively about space, but it's the basis for overturning some of the most basic intuitions that we've held for thousands of years. Until 1905, it was thought that everyone experiences the passage of time identically, that everyone agrees on what events occur at a given moment of time, and hence, that everyone would concur on what belongs on a